

Kushani Withanage

Employer Branding Executive | Content & Brand Experience



Experienced in Content Strategy, Brand Storytelling, Social Media, Events & Multimedia Production.

Specialized in Industry Engagement, Employer Branding, Stakeholder Collaboration & Experiential Programs.

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

Creative, hands-on marketing and content professional with experience across the IT education and technology sector, combining content creation, social media, event management, brand storytelling, industry engagement, and multimedia production. Skilled in taking projects from concept through execution, content production, publishing, and post-event promotion, while coordinating industry professionals, technology companies, vendors, and internal teams. Strong background developing podcasts, campaigns, event content, and industry workshops, delivering high-quality brand experiences.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Social Media & Analytics

- Social Media Content Strategy, Scheduling & YouTube Channel Management
- Content Performance Monitoring, Trend Research & Analytics-Led Optimization
- Community Building & Driving Real Conversation Around Brand Moments

Content Engine, Brand & Employer Storytelling

- Content Strategy, Copywriting & Employer Branding Storytelling
- Podcast & Video Content Development, Concept to Publishing, with Recording & Editing Direction
- Promotional Campaigns, Success Stories & Case-Study Content

Event Aesthetics & Brand Experience Design

- Event Concept, Branding & End-to-End Execution, including Large-Scale Industry Events (500+ Attendees)
- Physical-to-Digital Experience Translation, Ensuring Venues Convert to High-Quality Social Content
- Stage, Production, LED/Sound Setup & Visual Environment Coordination

Internal Communications & Project Ownership

- Internal Communications, Keeping Teams Aligned, Inspired & Informed on Brand Wins
- Concept-to-Execution Project Management & Strategic Initiative Coordination
- Independent Project Leadership & Cross-Functional Team Coordination (Academic, Technical, Marketing & Operational)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Head of Academic Affairs | Institute of Computer Engineering Technology

Jan 2024 – Present

Lead cross-functional academic, industry engagement, content, event, and student experience initiatives within a fast-growing IT education organization.

- Lead 15+ industry professionals and internal teams across academic and industry-facing initiatives, ensuring effective project execution and stakeholder alignment.
- Initiate and manage industry podcasts, workshops, events, student success stories, industry visits, and experiential learning programs from concept to execution and media publishing.
- Collaborate with marketing and multimedia teams to develop promotional campaigns, videos, event content, social media materials, and brand experiences.
- Build and maintain relationships with technology companies, industry leaders, government organizations, vendors, and external stakeholders.
- Lead large-scale events and programs involving 500+ students and parents, managing planning, logistics, vendors, production, and event experience.
- Coordinate content production workflows including topic research, scripting, recording, editing direction, final review, YouTube publishing, and social media promotion.
- Identify emerging technology and industry trends and convert them into relevant workshops, podcast topics, and student engagement initiatives.
- Support institutional brand positioning by creating opportunities for authentic industry, student, and employer stories.

Lecturer | Institute of Computer Engineering Technology

Jul 2023 – Jan 2025

- Deliver IT and software engineering education while collaborating with industry professionals to maintain practical and industry relevant content.
- Develop technical learning materials and support workshops, industry sessions, and student engagement initiatives.
- Contribute to academic projects, quality initiatives, and cross-functional institutional activities.

Assistant Lecturer | Institute of Computer Engineering Technology

Jan 2023 – Jun 2023

- Supported academic programs, student engagement, event coordination, and operational activities within a fast growing IT education environment.
- Assisted with stakeholder communication, academic documentation, student progress monitoring, and institutional projects.

KEY BRAND & MEDIA PROJECTS

Diploma Award Ceremony 2024/2025 – BMICH

Project Lead

iCET's first major graduation event, held at the Bandaranaike Memorial International Conference Hall (BMICH), Sri Lanka's premier national venue for large-scale conferences and ceremonies. I led the entire event from the ground up, bringing together 500+ students and parents for a milestone institutional moment.

Key Responsibilities

- **Comprehensive Event Operations & Execution:** Led complete event planning and execution, including venue, program flow, guest management, production, logistics, and media.
- **Cross-Functional Stakeholder Alignment:** Coordinated venue management, catering, guest speakers, production teams, vendors, and internal stakeholders.
- **Budgetary Management & Vendor Oversight:** Managed an event budget of approximately LKR 2M, including vendor coordination and cost control.
- **Experiential Brand & Visual Direction:** Managed event branding and physical experience including graduation cloaks, awards, certificates, printed materials, LED screens, sound, and stage setup.
- **Media Strategy & Production:** Developed strategy for photography, videography, promotional content, and social media coverage with the multimedia team.
- **Brand Identity & Quality Governance:** Ensured every visual touchpoint and piece of content stayed consistent with the institution's brand identity, from stage design to social posts.

Key Highlights

- Successfully led end-to-end execution for **500+ attendees** at Sri Lanka's top conference venue (BMICH).
- Managed a **budget of LKR 1.5M** while keeping operational execution aligned with institutional quality standards.
- Drove pre-event and live coverage campaigns that generated **10,000+ views** and **1,000+ engagements** across published media.

Media: [YouTube Live Stream](#) | [Official Event Trailer](#) | [LinkedIn Video](#) | [LinkedIn Post](#) | [Facebook Photo Album](#)

Industry Insights Podcast Series – YouTube

Content Strategist & Production Lead

An ongoing YouTube podcast I conceived and launched from scratch, featuring lead software engineers and tech executives in conversation about industry trends and career pathways, built to give students direct, authentic exposure to the software industry.

Key Responsibilities

- **Strategic Concept & Framework Leadership:** Founded and led an industry podcast series end-to-end concept, content direction, episode topics, and production workflow, positioning iCET as a platform connecting students with the software industry.
- **Executive Guest Sourcing & Trend Alignment:** Recruited and coordinated industry experts, including Lead Engineers and technology professionals, researching live tech trends to shape relevant, timely discussion topics.
- **End-to-End Production Pipeline Governance:** Owned the full production pipeline: guest coordination, content planning, recording, and publishing, working closely with the multimedia team on editing direction, visuals, thumbnails, and final cuts.
- **Multi-Channel Publishing Optimization:** Managed YouTube channel strategy and publishing titles, descriptions, topics, and content presentation alongside promotional and distribution strategies across digital platforms.

Key Highlights

- Produced short-form video cutdowns generating **150,000+ views across 8 Facebook** reels and **10,000+ views across 8 Instagram** videos.
- Scaled **YouTube channel reach to 10,000+ total views** across 4 published long-form core episodes.
- Built a recurring multimedia touchpoint bridging student talent with software engineering industry leaders.

Media: DevOps [Podcast Episodes](#) | Behind the Scenes [Facebook Reel](#) | [LinkedIn Post](#)

QA [Podcast Episodes](#) | [Facebook Real](#) | Behind the Scenes [Facebook Real](#) | [LinkedIn Post](#)

Software Engineering [Podcast Episode](#) | [Instergam Reel](#) | [LinkedIn Post](#)

Entrepreneurship [Podcast Episode](#) | [Facebook Reel](#)

Special [Facebook Reel](#) (138K views)

BuilderX Industry Workshop Series

Event Strategist & Campaign Lead

BuilderX is an industry-led, multi-track technical workshop initiative designed to bridge the gap between academic learning and high-demand tech skills (AI, DevOps, IoT). The initiative acts as a high-funnel community outreach and employer branding platform, bringing external students, industry leaders, and developers together through hands-on technical sessions.

Key Responsibilities

- **Campaign Content Creation & Speaker Alignment:** Conceptualized and executed the pre-event promotional strategy by scripting, producing, and managing video trailers, speaker announcements, and marketing collateral in direct collaboration with host.

- **Audience Nurturing & Attendance Conversion:** Managed registration communication and audience engagement to convert online interest into physical attendance.
- **Multi-Hall Technical Event Production:** Coordinated presenters, academic, technical, and multimedia teams to run simultaneous sessions across multiple lecture halls, including live technical setup.
- **User-Generated Advocacy & Asset Distribution:** Drove organic brand visibility by encouraging student generated content and post event social sharing, alongside certificates, photography, and video coverage.

Key Highlights

- Generated **13,000+ organic video views** across social channels through targeted pre-event marketing campaigns and speaker teaser content.
- Drove **600+ online registrations via website**, achieving a **67% attendance** conversion rate with **400+ physical participants**.
- Captured **600+ prospective student lead inquiries** directly from organic social promotional campaigns.
- Sparked **200+ participant LinkedIn posts tagging iCET**, significantly expanding brand visibility across professional and developer networks.
- Strengthened online brand reputation with **100+ positive Google Reviews** across two workshop sessions.

Media: DevOps Official Launch - [Facebook Video](#) | [Facebook Post](#) | [Instagram](#)
 DevOps Promotional Video - [Facebook Video](#) | [Instagram](#)
 AI Promotional Video - [Facebook](#) | [Instagram](#) | [Facebook Post](#)

KEY BRAND & MEDIA PROJECTS

Industry Minds – Experiential Learning Program

Program Lead

Led an experiential learning program connecting students with real businesses, tech companies, and government bodies. Personally mentored students through the last 2 editions, not a standard problem-solving format, but one built around identifying genuine human needs before defining the problem.

Key Responsibilities

- Launched and led the program end-to-end, bridging academic learning with real-world business challenges across multiple Sri Lankan industries and government processes.
- Built and maintained relationships with companies, government bodies, and industry stakeholders, coordinating industry visits, research projects, mentorships, and stakeholder meetings.
- Personally mentored students through a human-centered approach, guiding them to uncover real needs rather than just solve pre-set problems.

- Owned program branding and promotional materials in collaboration with marketing and multimedia teams.

Media: [Industry Minds 2025](#)

Student Success Story Series

Content Strategist & Production Lead

Conceived and built an original, non-traditional student storytelling series from scratch, moving away from the standard "success story" format to instead capture the personal connection between students and lecturers, and the classroom memories that shaped their journey. The concept, structure, and creative direction were entirely self-initiated, designed to make institutional storytelling feel authentic rather than promotional.

Key Responsibilities

- Originated the entire concept and episode structure myself, breaking away from iCET's traditional success-story format to build a more personal, memory-driven narrative style.
- Coordinated students and lecturers to bring each story to life, ensuring every voice in the episode felt genuine rather than scripted.
- Defined the interview flow and storytelling structure end-to-end, deliberately shaping the core message each episode needed to land with its audience for maximum marketing impact.
- Directed video editors on how to integrating photographs, personal memories, supporting footage, and social media storytelling techniques.
- Owned final review and sign-off on every edit before publication, protecting the creative vision of the format I built.

Media: YouTube – [Success Story Episode 01](#)

Company-Led Technology Workshops

Industry Relations & Event Coordinator

Coordinated workshops conducted by software companies to expose students to current technologies, industry culture, and career opportunities.

Key Responsibilities

- Coordinated with participating technology companies and industry professionals.
- Developed communication activities to increase student participation.
- Coordinated photography, video, and social media coverage.

- Worked with the multimedia team to produce event content.

Media: [Tecciance Session 02](#) | [Maash](#) | [Tecciance Session 01](#) | [Nexova](#)

Zone24x7 Industry Exposure Visit

Project & Media Coordinator

Coordinated and build direct connection with company an industry exposure visit, providing students with direct exposure to a professional software engineering environment.

Key Responsibilities

- Coordinated directly with company leadership and HR representatives.
- Managed pre-visit communication, scheduling, student coordination, and logistics.
- Planned media coverage and coordinated the multimedia team.
- Managed student transportation and on-site coordination.
- Supported post-event social media content creation.

Media: [LinkedIn Post](#) | [LinkedIn Video](#)

Inauguration Day – New Intake

Program & Event Lead

Managed large-scale intake inauguration programs welcoming **500+ physical and online students**, combining academic orientation, industry sessions, technology setup, and brand communication.

Key Responsibilities

- Planned and coordinated full-day programs involving 500+ students.
- Coordinated industry experts, Lead Engineers, speakers, and internal teams.
- Managed simultaneous physical and online sessions.
- Coordinated speaker schedules and event timelines.
- Worked with marketing and multimedia teams on photography, video, and promotional content.
- Ensured smooth coordination between academic, technical, marketing, and operational teams.

Media: [2026 June Intake](#) | [2026 Jan Intake](#) | [2025 June Intake](#)

Government Industry Research Project – Department of Motor Traffic

Project Coordinator

Coordinated a three-month internal research project with the Department of Motor Traffic, providing students with practical exposure to a government organization and real-world business processes.

Key Responsibilities

- Maintained direct communication with DMT management and project stakeholders.
- Coordinated 10+ student researchers throughout the project.
- Managed project communication, timelines, research activities, and stakeholder requirements.
- Guided students throughout research and documentation.
- Coordinated successful completion and handover of the final research output.

Media: [Department of Motor Traffic \(DMT\) Project](#)

Laya Outbound Leadership Program

Program Coordinator

Coordinated full-day leadership and team-building programs conducted with Sri Lankan Army trainers.

Key Responsibilities

- Planned program schedules, logistics, accommodation, transportation, and training arrangements.
- Coordinated communication with students, parents, trainers, hotels, and transportation providers.
- Managed participant experience and operational execution.
- Coordinated event documentation and media coverage.

Media: LinkedIn – [Outbound Training 2025](#)

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Information Technology

In Progress, Expected October 2026

University of Colombo School of Computing (UCSC)

Higher Diploma in Information Technology (65 Credits)

October 2025

University of Colombo School of Computing (UCSC)

Diploma in Digital Marketing

Jan 2025 – Jan 2024

Sri Lanka Institute of Marketing (SLIM)

G.C.E. Advanced Level (Maths Stream)

2019

Sri Sumangala Balika Vidyalaya - Panadura

- Results: Combined Maths (C), Physics (B), Chemistry (B)

G.C.E. Ordinary Level

2015

Sri Sumangala Balika Vidyalaya - Panadura

- Results: 8 A's, 1 B

LANGUAGES

Sinhala: Native / Bilingual proficiency**English:** Professional working proficiency**Tamil:** Limited working proficiency